

The system requirements for Windows 1.0.1 were MS-DOS 2.0, 256 KB of RAM, and two double-sided disk drives or a hard drive. The market share for Windows 1.0.1 grew very slowly; users were more than willing to remain on the DOS interface. Serious graphic and DTP work was done on the Macintosh platform.

1984

Enter The Mac

January: The Other Side

Considered a mere toy when launched in January 1984, the Macintosh went on to become a worthy contender to Windows—as you know all too well.

When launched, the Macintosh, commonly referred to as the Mac, had a Motorola 8 MHz processor, 128 KB of RAM, and a custom OS. The Mac did have a fan to cool the CPU, thus resulting in many systems overheating and crashing, giving it the nickname “the beige toaster.” The Mac did not have an internal hard drive, but had a crisp 9-inch mono display. The unit had a keyboard without the numeric keys or navigational arrows, and the now-infamous one-buttoned mouse. It sold for \$2,500 (equivalent to Rs 1,30,000 now!).



The beige toaster, aka Macintosh (original)

When launched, the Mac came with MacPaint and MacWrite. Software like MacTerminal and MacProject was added later. All these were written exclusively for the Mac GUI. Many users, who were only used to text-based terminal windows, were unimpressed. Application developers too did not initially bother to port their applications to this GUI-rich environment.